

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Splunk | SPL | Detection Engineering | SIEM Tuning

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Detection Engineer with over five years of experience designing, building, testing and maintaining high-quality detection content across enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms. I have strong, hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and practical experience with Splunk using Search Processing Language (SPL), enabling me to turn monitoring requirements and threat intelligence use cases into effective, actionable detections. I have demonstrated expertise in tuning detection rules to reduce false positives and improve analyst efficiency, mapping detection logic to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and delivering detection content that protects critical systems and clients in real time. I complement this with experience in Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and incident response. I am eligible for Security Check (SC) Clearance and am seeking a hands-on detection engineering role where I can help a high-performing SOC team deliver and continuously improve detection capability at scale.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering and SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL detection rule development, testing and tuning), Splunk (SPL, detection use cases), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, detection content lifecycle management, false positive reduction, alert tuning
- **EDR and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR)
- **SOAR and Automation:** SOAR playbook development, PowerShell scripting, automated incident triage workflows, alert enrichment automation
- **Threat Intelligence and Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK-led detection development and threat hunting, indicator of compromise (IOC) analysis, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactive threat hunting using KQL
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 Incident Response framework, containment, eradication and recovery coordination, post-incident analysis
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA (Multifactor Authentication), SSO (Single Sign-On), BeyondTrust PAM (Privileged Access Management)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK (detection mapping and threat hunting), NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast email security, Check Point Harmony firewall, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Design, build, test and deploy detection content across Microsoft Sentinel, writing and optimising detection logic using KQL to turn monitoring requirements and threat intelligence use cases into effective, actionable detections
- Continuously tune SIEM alerts and detection rules to reduce false positives and improve analyst efficiency, ensuring detection fidelity keeps pace with evolving adversary techniques
- Map detection logic to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, ensuring systematic coverage of relevant threat actor tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs) and identifying gaps in detection coverage
- Manage and operate CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel, maintaining unified visibility across the endpoint and cloud environment and maintaining detection rules across both platforms

- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks using PowerShell to automate alert triage, enrichment and response actions, reducing mean time to respond and manual analyst burden
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using KQL in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying latent threats not surfaced by automated detection rules
- Lead incident response activities following the NIST SP 800-61 framework, coordinating containment, eradication and recovery for confirmed security incidents
- Deploy and manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users, integrating XDR telemetry into the detection and response workflow
- Manage vulnerability assessment programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera BAS, using findings to inform and validate detection coverage
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM platform and enforce identity security controls via Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access and MFA/SSO

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and investigated security alerts across SIEM and EDR platforms, triaging events and escalating confirmed incidents in line with documented procedures
- Supported development and tuning of SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, working to reduce false positive rates and improve detection coverage
- Performed threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, identifying endpoint anomalies and indicators of compromise and contributing to detection improvement
- Supported vulnerability assessment activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, tracking remediation and reporting risk exposure to management
- Contributed to incident response activities and post-incident lessons learnt reviews, incorporating findings into updated detection logic and response runbooks
- Contributed to the successful delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating compliance with NCSC baseline security controls
- Administered identity access controls in Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), supporting Conditional Access policy reviews and MFA enforcement

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported security operations and monitoring activities in a Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech environment, including deployment and management of endpoint security tooling
- Conducted infrastructure security assessments and implemented improvements to access controls and endpoint protection, informing detection and monitoring requirements
- Assisted with quality assurance for security controls and documented security procedures, configurations and operational runbooks
- Collaborated with development and infrastructure teams to embed security monitoring and detection requirements throughout the infrastructure and application lifecycle

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and continuously tuned KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing false positive alert volumes and improving Security Operations Centre (SOC) analyst efficiency across the University of the Arts London estate
- Designed and maintained CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM detection content to complement Sentinel coverage, providing multi-platform detection depth aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Deployed SOAR playbooks using PowerShell automation to handle alert triage and enrichment, significantly reducing mean time to respond and manual analyst workload
- Delivered proactive threat hunting campaigns that identified latent adversary activity not surfaced by automated detection, enabling earlier containment and reduced organisational risk exposure
- Led enterprise deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users, integrating XDR telemetry into SIEM detection and response workflows to improve detection fidelity
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating adherence to NCSC baseline controls and supporting the organisation's security compliance posture

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Farnborough/Remote, UK)